

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

One Service Picture, Three Different Systems

What leaders should authorize, require, and refuse

Production Unit	PU-B07-C55
Decision status	Controlled learning asset
Audience	Executives, programme owners, statisticians, technical leads
Data	Synthetic examples only

Executive takeaway: Create a coherent WASH service picture by reconciling infrastructure, service delivery, household experience, quality, reliability, accessibility, and institutional responsibility.

Why it matters

Infrastructure presence can be mistaken for reliable service when water is unsafe, intermittent, unaffordable, inaccessible, or poorly maintained.

Illustrative application

A municipality compares network records, provider operations, and household evidence before declaring an area served.

Minimum approval conditions

- Named accountable owner and lawful purpose
- Defined evidence, provenance, reference period, population, and geography
- Decision-relevant validation and visible uncertainty
- Documented abstention, referral, override, and incident processes
- Accessibility, equity, security, retention, and retirement review

Non-negotiable boundary

The analytical system may inform review. It may not independently authorize benefits, sanctions, enforcement, clinical treatment, school exclusion, displacement, or another consequential action.